



Wired Headphones

How high can you fly?

The sky's the limit and we can see it from the ground. That is the only phrase that can be used to describe the Wired

Headphones category. In this category, we have everything from entry level studio monitors that can be purchased for a few thousand rupees to luxury offerings that can cost over ₹5,00,000. Studio monitors have a flat sound signature, without any colours in the sound, meaning that you get a very plain audio coming from the headphones. These headphones are known to be some of the most expensive ones available. However, if you spend some more money and move into the luxury audio segment, the tables turn. You get a very finely tuned audio where you have just the right amount of the bass, mids, and highs mixed together to form this beautiful drink that you don't want to ever finish. We went the extra mile to test a variety of headphones this year. Let's see which one comes out on top.

Winner: Audio-Technica ATH-AWKT

With a price of ₹2,75,000, the Audio-Technica ATH-AWKT immediately caught the attention of the folks at the Digit Test Centre. When we hooked it

up to the audio interface, and started playing some high quality FLAC files, they did not fail to impress us. The headphones had a balanced sound signature with the right mix of all the frequencies thrown in. Despite them being a pair of closed back headphones, the sound stage was very impressive to say the least. You do lose out on a bit of the clamping pressure. The bass is punchy, yet subtle, and the mids and the highs were registering their presence with authority. Every instrument in the tracks that we played, across the board, had all the instruments clearly heard and represented as they would have been envisioned by the artist. Overall, it deserves the win in this category, without an ounce of doubt.

Runner-up: Neumann NDH 30

The Neumann NDH30 fought well and planted themselves at the runner's up spot in our Digit Zero1 Awards. While the Audio-Technica headphones are

meant for luxury listening, the Neumann NDH30 is a pair of headphones that is used to master those songs in studios. They stood to the standards we had set for the headphones and gave us a sound that is perfect for being used in studios to master and monitor tracks. The bass was deep and bouncy. The mids and highs were perfectly balanced, however, due to the lack of colouration in the audio, they might sound a bit harsh in daily use. For anyone looking to buy headphones for day to day use, they may find these underwhelming because their sound is so colourless and bland. However, for professionals like studio managers and sound engineers, these headphones make perfect sense.

Best Buy: Sennheiser HD 400 PRO

The Sennheiser HD 400 PRO in our testing turned out to be the best pair of headphones that you can get your hands on, if you are looking to get the most out of the money that you spend. Their sound signature is not as flat as the Neumann NDH 30, but comes pretty close. It is flat enough for most professional audio mastering and monitoring work. As for the design, these headphones have an open back design that helps in widening the soundstage. It is a deserving winner of the Best Buy Award due to the competitive pricing and solid sound signature.

— Satvik Pandey | satvik@digit.in



Audio-Technica ATH-AWKT

Price: Starting at ₹2,75,000



Neumann NDH 30
Price: ₹52,900

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2022



Sennheiser HD 400 PRO
Price: ₹21,900